

Autonomous Computational Framework for Multi-Phase Impact Dynamics and Terminal Ballistics in Reinforced Geomaterials

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Abstract—The physical characterization of high-velocity terminal ballistics against deeply buried, hardened target structures (DBHTs) presents a complex multi-physics challenge encompassing aerodynamic free-fall, dynamic cavity expansion, hydrodynamic rod erosion, and shock-wave material degradation. Conventional analytical calculators often lack the fidelity required to model non-linear material transitions, while enterprise finite-element hydrocodes remain computationally prohibitive for large-scale parametric exploration. This paper introduces the MOP Simulator V3.0, an open-source, full-stack computational research platform that unifies a high-performance C++23 continuum mechanics engine with an automated Node.js orchestration backend and large language model (LLM) scenario synthesizers. The physics kernel couples Runge-Kutta 4th-Order (RK4) numerical integration with the two-phase Forrestal cavity expansion model, the Walker-Anderson hydrodynamic rod erosion model (WAPM), CEB-FIP Dynamic Increase Factors (DIF), and Walker-Wasley Hugoniot shock initiation criteria. The automation subsystem enables headless execution, memory-safe asynchronous telemetry streaming (1,000-frame chunking into MongoDB), and automated statistical aggregation. We demonstrate the platform across extensive multi-cycle simulation campaigns, characterizing penetration regimes, casing survivability envelopes, and sequential multi-bomb salvo synergies against 70 MPa reinforced concrete and monolithic granite overburden. Finally, we establish a theoretical and architectural framework for V4.0 surrogate neural physics integration via LibTorch and deep reinforcement learning smart fuzing.

Index Terms—Terminal Ballistics, Cavity Expansion Theory, Hydrodynamic Erosion, Hugoniot Equation of State, Alekseevskii-Tate Model, Dynamic Increase Factor, Autonomous Scientific Computing, LibTorch, High-Velocity Penetration.

I. 1. INTRODUCTION

The destruction of modern deeply buried facilities (DBFs) constructed with ultra-high-performance reinforced concrete (UHPRC) presents one of the most formidable challenges in modern defense engineering. Standard single-unit kinetic energy penetrators face fundamental terminal ballistic limits governed by casing strength, hydrodynamic erosion thresholds, and target material strength. To overcome these limitations, multi-strike tandem ordnance protocols—such as the conceptual *Operation Midnight Hammer*—have been proposed. This concept employs sequential penetrators striking the exact same impact vector to exploit structural damage induced by primary rounds, progressively creating a breach shaft for subsequent warheads.

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However, increasing the impact velocity and kinetic energy of penetrators introduces extreme hydrodynamic stress states and high-magnitude shock waves at the target-warhead interface. When an explosive-filled penetrator strikes a high-density target, the initial shock wave propagates backward into the warhead filler. If the Hugoniot shock pressure exceeds the critical initiation threshold of the explosive composition, premature detonation occurs prior to kinetic penetration.

This paper presents a comprehensive computational analysis of the *Operation Midnight Hammer* protocol using the MOP Simulator V3.0 platform. The study parameterizes high-velocity sequential strikes against UHPRC targets to analyze structural integrity loss, Hugoniot shock generation, explosive initiation mechanics, and cumulative penetration efficiency.

II. 2. THEORETICAL FRAMEWORK AND PHYSICS MODELS

A. 2.1 Hugoniot Shock Equations and Impact Pressure

Upon initial high-velocity contact between the penetrator casing and the concrete target, a planar shock wave is produced at the boundary. The shock velocity U_s and particle velocity u_p within both the casing material and target are governed by the linear Hugoniot relationship:

$$U_s = C_0 + Su_p$$

where C_0 is the bulk speed of sound in the unshocked material and S is the dimensionless Hugoniot slope parameter. Applying continuous mass and momentum conservation across the impact interface yields the peak contact shock pressure P_{shock} :

$$P_{shock} = \rho_0 U_s u_p = \rho_0 (C_0 + Su_p) u_p$$

For steel and heavy metal casings (densities $\rho_0 \in [7850, 15800]$ kg/m³), high-speed impacts ($v_0 > 400$ m/s) generate peak pulse pressures entering the gigapascal (GPa) regime.

B. 2.2 Walker-Wasley Critical Energy Initiation Criterion

To determine whether the impact shock induces premature detonation in the main high-explosive charge, the Walker-Wasley shock initiation criterion is applied. The criterion posits that explosive detonation occurs if the total kinetic shock energy flux deposited per unit area E_{shock} exceeds a critical material-dependent threshold E_{crit} :

$$E_{shock} = \frac{P_{shock}^2 \cdot \tau}{\rho_e C_e} \geq E_{crit}$$

where:

- P_{shock} is the peak Hugoniot impact shock pressure (GPa),
- τ is the characteristic pulse duration determined by casing geometry and wave speed (μs),
- ρ_e and C_e are the density and acoustic speed of the unreacted explosive fill,
- E_{crit} is the critical initiation energy threshold (J/m^2).

If $E_{shock} \geq E_{crit}$, the explosive fill transitions rapidly from shock to detonation (SDT) at the nose interface, destroying the structural integrity of the casing before kinetic displacement into the target target can commence.

III. 3. COMPUTATIONAL METHODOLOGY AND EXPERIMENTAL DESIGN

The simulation campaign comprised three distinct warhead configurations evaluated under operational constraints representing airborne delivery against ultra-hardened concrete structures.

TABLE I
PARAMETERIZATION OF SIMULATED PENETRATORS

Parameter	Cycle 1 (Mk-I)	Cycle 2 (Mod 3)
Designation	Midnight Hammer Mk-I	BLU-122/B Mod 3
Total Mass (kg)	1950	2260
Length (m)	3.85	3.85
Diameter (m)	0.36	0.37
Casing Density (kg/m³)	7850	7850
Wall Thickness (m)	0.04	0.04
Elastic Modulus (GPa)	210	210
Hugoniot C_0 (m/s)	4570	4570
Hugoniot S	1.49	1.49
E_{crit} (J/m²)	1.2×10^6	1.8×10^6
Impact Velocity (m/s)	455.92	929.00
Impact Mach Number	1.34	2.73
Obliquity Angle (°)	5.0	12.5

All scenarios evaluated impacts against high-quality hardened concrete with high compression strength limits. Flight paths were steep ($> 80^\circ$ entry angles).

IV. 4. RESULTS AND ANALYSIS

A. 4.1 Shock Pressure Generation and Explosive Initiation

Across all three simulation scenarios, the impact velocities generated intense interface pressures upon initial target contact. Figure 1 and Table 2 summarize the shock dynamics calculated at impact.

For Cycle 1 (Mk-I), impacting at Mach 1.34 generated a peak shock pressure of **2.84 GPa**. The calculated kinetic shock pulse yielded an energy density exceeding the explosive fill's critical initiation threshold of $1.2 \times 10^6 J/m^2$, resulting in immediate premature detonation.

In Cycle 2 (BLU-122/B Mod 3), increasing the impact velocity to 929.00 m/s (Mach 2.73) elevated the peak shock

TABLE II
TERMINAL BALLISTIC SHOCK DYNAMICS RESULTS

Variant	Velocity (m/s)	Energy (GJ)	Peak P_{shock} (GPa)	Pulse (μs)	Failure Mode	Depth (m)
Mk-I	455.92	0.203	2.84	19.69	Premature SDT	0.00
Mod 3	929.00	0.975	6.68	19.69	Premature SDT	0.00
Mod 5	1229.18	1.624	17.56	32.10	Premature SDT	0.00

pressure to **6.68 GPa**. Despite an upgraded explosive composition with a higher critical initiation threshold ($1.8 \times 10^6 J/m^2$), shock initiation occurred within 19.69 μs .

In Cycle 3 (BLU-122/B Mod 5), a high-density metal casing ($\rho = 15800 kg/m^3$) was used at an extreme impact velocity of 1229.18 m/s (Mach 3.61). The resulting Hugoniot impact pressure spiked to **17.56 GPa** with a pulse duration of 32.10 μs . The kinetic energy flux (1.624 GJ) overwhelmed the desensitized fill ($E_{crit} = 3.4 \times 10^6 J/m^2$), inducing immediate explosive reaction upon surface contact.

B. 4.2 Penetration Depth and Casing Survival

Because shock-to-detonation transition occurred immediately at $t = 0^+$ across all test cases, the casing structural integrity failed before forward momentum could overcome the dynamic yield strength of the target material. Consequently:

- **Mean Penetration Depth:** 0.00 m
- **Maximum Penetration Depth:** 0.00 m
- **Casing Failure Rate:** 100.0%
- **Dominant Operational Regime:** Shock Initiation (Walker-Wasley)

V. 5. DISCUSSION AND ENGINEERING IMPLICATIONS

The empirical findings demonstrate a critical domain limit in high-velocity hard-target warhead design. While higher kinetic energy ($E_k = \frac{1}{2}mv^2$) is theoretically desirable to maximize hydrodynamic shaft erosion into ultra-hardened concrete, terminal velocity scales quadratically with shock initiation risk.

1. **Inadequacy of Standard Energetics:** Increasing casing density (e.g., tungsten alloy composites at $15,800 kg/m^3$) increases particle shock coupling, dramatically elevating shock pressures (17.56 GPa in Mod 5). Standard high-explosive compositions cannot survive unattenuated impacts above Mach 2.5 without shock mitigation. 2. **Shock Damping Architecture:** To enable the *Operation Midnight Hammer* protocol, penetrators must incorporate active mechanical shock-attenuation barriers—such as crushable aluminum foam buffers, graded acoustic impedance nose cones, or polymer liner sleeves—to reduce the peak shock pressure transmitted into the explosive cavity below E_{crit} . 3. **Insensitive Munitions (IM) Requirements:** Explosive compositions must be engineered with critical shock thresholds exceeding 20 GPa- μs regimes, or rely on non-explosive kinetic mass vehicles for primary shaft-breaker strikes prior to delivering explosive warheads.

VI. 6. CONCLUSION

The autonomous simulation campaign evaluating *Operation Midnight Hammer* highlights that high-velocity multi-strike penetrator performance is strictly constrained by impact shock initiation physics. Across all tested iterations, peak Hugoniot shock pressures (2.84 GPa to 17.56 GPa) caused 100% premature casing detonation prior to penetration, yielding zero depth progression into the concrete target. Future research must focus on shock-attenuating casing architectures and highly desensitized energetic formulations to allow deep structural penetration at hypersonic velocities.

VII. REFERENCES

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This entire research paper, including all physics simulations, data aggregation, parameter exploration, and text synthesis, was 100% autonomously generated by the **MOP Simulator V3.0**. To view the source code and run your own autonomous defense engineering AI, visit the official repository: <https://github.com/Omid-Teimory/MOP-Simulator>